

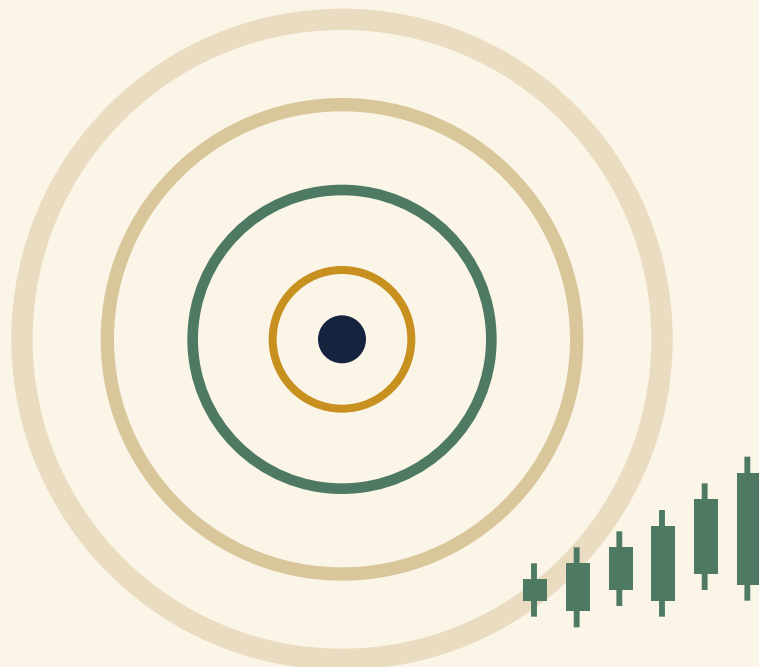
WORKBOOK 5

BEFORE THE RUN

Excited and scared at the same time

*What the last 4 cycles actually did, and what
the feelings do to your money*

BY ANNA MACKO



THE YEAR I SPENT WAITING

I found Bitcoin in 2012, and I studied it for a whole year before I bought any.

I read everything I could find. I watched the price every day. I planned my trade.

In 2013 I bought my first whole Bitcoin at around \$100. I watched it climb, and when it got to my number I sold, at about 8 times what I put in, which is what I had planned for. It took me 3 days to get it all out. I was happy. I had planned that trade for a year and it worked, and I felt like a crypto goddess.

But here is what I see now that I did not see then. That year of studying could have been a year of trading. Small trades, careful trades, learning as I went. Bitcoin went through more than one cycle back then, up and down and up again, and I sat and watched them because I was waiting for the perfect moment in the perfect cycle.

There is no perfect moment. There is your plan, and there is starting it, even small, even while you are still learning.

That was more than 10 years ago. I have traded every cycle since. I have made a lot, I have lost a lot, and I have built it back, and I am going to tell you about all of that in this book, including the parts I do not enjoy telling.

Why I am starting there

Because something is starting to move again. You can feel it. It is in the charts, it is in the group chats, and it is in the way people who never mention crypto have suddenly started mentioning crypto.

And whatever happens over the next couple of years, there will be people who make life changing money and then give most of it back. That is not a prediction, it is just what happens every single time, and it is almost never because they were wrong about the market.

So this book is not about picking coins. There are other classes for that. This one is about the person doing the picking, and about what excitement and fear and urgency actually do to your decisions when there is real money on the screen.

And I will tell you now what I want for you. Not just that you make money in this run, although I hope you do. I want you to come out the other side of it as somebody who can handle money, handle being wrong, handle waiting, and handle a very loud few months without losing yourself in them. Those things make you a better trader and they also, genuinely, make you a better person to be around. I have watched it happen to my students and I have watched it happen to me.

A PROMISE ABOUT THE NUMBERS

Please read this page before the exciting ones.

I am going to show you some patterns in this book that are genuinely remarkable. One of them is so consistent that it made me sit back in my chair when I first checked it properly.

And I need you to hold every bit of it loosely.

Here is my promise to you. I am not going to tell you what Bitcoin is going to do. I do not know. Nobody knows, and anybody who tells you otherwise with a straight face is selling you something, and it is probably not a workbook.

What I can do is show you what happened in the cycles we have already had, count the days properly, source it all, and then be honest with you about how small the sample is. The sample is 4. Bitcoin has only had 4 of these cycles, and only 3 of them are old enough to really count. Three is not a lot. If you flipped a coin 3 times and it landed heads every time, you would not bet your house on the next flip.

So when you get to the day counts, please hold 2 thoughts at the same time. The pattern is real and worth knowing. And the pattern could break this time, for reasons that are already visible to everybody: the exchange traded funds (ETFs, which let people buy Bitcoin through a normal stock account), the institutional money (big funds and companies), the regulation, and a macro picture (interest rates, inflation, the wider economy) that looks nothing like 2017 did.

Nothing in this book is financial advice, and I am not going to tell you what to buy, when to buy it, or what it will be worth. I talk to you like we are friends, because that is what this is. What I will do is help you make your own decisions from a calmer place, with a written plan and a clearer head, and honestly that is the part that decides most outcomes anyway.



PART 1

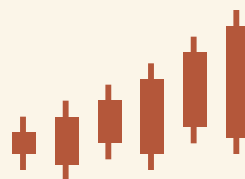
RIGHT NOW, WHILE IT IS STILL QUIET

Two feelings are running in you at the same time. Let us get them out on the table.

Everything in this part is easier to do now than it will be in 3 months, and that is precisely why it is at the front.

You are going to write down what you are actually hoping for, find the number that changes how you behave, and make one decision in advance that we will come back to much later in the book.

- 1** **The 2 feelings**
- 2** **What you are really hoping for**
- 3** **The number that changes you**
- 4** **The trade you have not taken yet**



1.1

THE 2 FEELINGS AT THE SAME TIME

Both of these are running right now, and that is not a contradiction.

You are excited. Let us just say that out loud, because most people will not, and pretending otherwise is a strange way to start a book about honesty.

Part of you has already done the math on what a good run would mean. Not the modest version you would say at a party. The real one. The debt gone. The trip. The year off. The thing you have not said out loud to anybody.

And underneath the excitement, in exactly the same body, at exactly the same moment, there is fear.

Fear that you will get it wrong again. Fear that you will be late, or early, or in the wrong coin, or right about the coin and wrong about the timing. Fear that everybody else understands something you do not. And underneath all of those, the big one: fear that you will watch this whole thing happen from the outside and then have to live with having watched it.

Both of those are running in you right now. That is not a contradiction and it is not a flaw in your character. That is simply what a nervous system does when something important might be about to happen and the outcome is not in your control.

These are real sentences from real people who got on a call with my team. We went through hundreds of those conversations, and the same handful of feelings were underneath almost every one.

"I keep hearing about investing in crypto, I hear the good and the bad."

"I have no idea what I am doing."

"I have zero experience. Never done it. Do not know much about it."

"Time has been my biggest enemy."

And if you have been trading for years, yours probably sounds different. Less "I have no idea what I am doing" and more "I know exactly what to do, and I am scared I will not do it when it counts."

If any of those sounded like something you have thought, I want you to know how ordinary that is. It is not a sign that you are not cut out for this. It is a sign that you are paying attention.

What are you actually feeling about this run? Write both halves, the hopeful and the frightened, and do not tidy either up.

Why this helps: *a feeling you have named has much less power to make your decisions for you.*

1.2

WHAT YOU ARE REALLY HOPING FOR

The honest version, not the sensible one.

I want you to write down the real story you are telling yourself about what this could do for your life.

Not the reasonable version. Everybody has a reasonable version, and it is usually something like "it would be nice to have a bit more security". That is not what is actually running in the background at 11 at night and you know it.

The reason this matters is not motivational. It is practical, and it is this. An unexamined hope will make your decisions for you. If you are secretly hoping this run pays off a specific debt by a specific date, that hope will quietly change your position sizing (how much you put into each trade), your patience, and how you behave on a red day, and you will not notice it happening because you never said it out loud.

Written down, it is a goal you can plan around. Unwritten, it is a pressure you cannot see.

"The most dangerous risk of all is spending your life not doing what you want, betting you can buy yourself the freedom to do it later." @lovingnotworking

What would a genuinely good run mean for your life? Write the real one.

Why this helps: *once the real goal is on paper, you can plan for it instead of letting it push you around.*

Now the harder question. What are you hoping money will fix that money might not actually fix?

Why this helps: *it stops you chasing a number to fix something a number cannot fix.*

1.3

THE NUMBER THAT CHANGES YOU

Everybody has one. Most people have never gone looking for it.

Somewhere above your current account balance there is a number at which you would start behaving differently. Not thinking differently. BEHAVING differently.

For most people it is not where they expect it to be, and finding it in advance is one of the more useful things you can do with 20 minutes.

At what account value would you start behaving differently? Circle one, or write your own.

Why this helps: *you will know in advance the size where you need to slow down and check yourself.*

\$10,000	\$50,000	\$100,000	\$500,000	\$1M	other
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Now imagine your account hits that number tomorrow morning. Go through these honestly.

IF I WERE AT THAT NUMBER...	YES / NO	AND WHAT WOULD THAT LOOK LIKE?
Would I check the charts more often?		
Would I become more protective of it?		
Would I take bigger risks with it?		
Would I tell people? Which people?		
Would I start calculating houses, cars, quitting?		
Would losing 10% of it feel different, even though 10% is still 10%?		

That last row is the important one. 10% is 10% at every account size, and almost nobody feels it that way. If losing 10% of the big number would feel much worse than losing 10% of what you have now, you have found the point where your judgment changes. Plenty of people scale up, start trading worse and never figure out why. Their strategy was fine. It was being run by a different nervous system.

It works the other way too. Treat your \$1,000 account the way you would treat your \$1M account. People blow through small accounts because they do not seem to matter, so they crank up the leverage (borrowed money that makes every move bigger). The habits you build on the small one are the ones you take to the big one.

1.4

THE TRADE YOU HAVE NOT TAKEN YET

Answer this now. We are coming back to it in Part 7.

Read the scene below and write down what you would actually do. Not what you think the correct answer is. What you would DO.

No trick and no right answer. In Part 7 you will come back and read what you wrote today.

BULL RUN SIMULATOR 1

The one that went without you

You have \$100,000 in your account.

A coin you have had your eye on for weeks, and nearly bought 3 days ago, is up 60% since you looked at it.

Everybody in the Discord is talking about it. Somebody has just posted a screenshot showing they are up \$28,000 on it.

While you are reading that message, it moves another 12%.

What do you do next?

And what are you feeling in your body while you decide?

Why this helps: you catch your honest first instinct now, so in Part 7 you can see exactly what changed.

Do not turn back to this page. Write it, close it, and keep going. It will be a much more interesting exercise in Part 7 if you have genuinely forgotten what you put.



PART 2

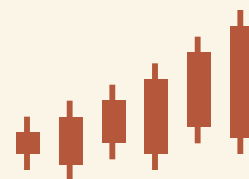
WHY YOU FEEL LATE

And the cure for it, which turns out to be arithmetic.

You might be wondering what Bitcoin cycle data is doing in a book about how you feel. Quite a lot, actually.

Because one of the easiest ways to make genuinely terrible decisions is to believe you are running out of time. Urgency is the most expensive feeling in trading, and the numbers in this part are the antidote to it.

- 1 Urgency is the expensive one**
- 2 1,068 days. 1,061. 1,050.**
- 3 The cycle starts later than you think**
- 4 The multiples are getting smaller**
- 5 What if the cycle breaks**



2.1

URGENCY IS THE EXPENSIVE ONE

Before the numbers, here is why the numbers matter.

Think about the worst trades you have taken. Not the ones where you were wrong about the market, the ones you actually regret.

I would bet almost all of them share one feature, and it is not bad analysis. It is that you felt you had to act RIGHT THEN. There was no time to check. No time to wait for a better entry. No time to sleep on it. If you did not move now, the thing would be gone.

That feeling is where the money goes. Not into being wrong, into being rushed.

And the reason I am putting a chapter of cycle research in a book about your feelings is that the single most effective thing I have ever found for urgency is not a breathing exercise. It is knowing roughly how long these things actually take.

Because when you genuinely understand that the up leg of a cycle has historically run for the better part of 3 years, the panic about being 3 days late stops making sense. Not because you talked yourself out of it. Because it is the wrong emotion at the wrong scale, and you can see that it is.

The universe runs on its own clock. You are the one who is rushing, and the rushing is where the anxiety comes from. Let go a little, and trust.

So read the next few pages as psychology, because that is what they are.

One thing before we start. I have checked every number in this part against the actual price data and the published research, rather than repeating what circulates online, so you can trust what you are reading.

2.2

1,068 DAYS. 1,061. 1,050.

Roughly a year down. Then about 1,000 days back up.

THE NUMBERS, CHECKED

Measuring from each all time high down to the following cycle low, and then from that low back up to the next all time high:

The down legs: 410 days, then 363 days, then 376 days. An average of 383.

The up legs: 1,068 days, then 1,061 days, then 1,050 days. **An average of 1,060.**

Turning points cross-checked against Fidelity Digital Assets, "Four-Year Bitcoin and Crypto Cycles" (2026), using Bloomberg data.

Look at those 3 up leg numbers again, slowly. 1,068. 1,061. 1,050.

Three separate cycles, spread across more than a decade. Completely different market conditions each time. Different regulation, different technology, different players, and one of the biggest crashes in the history of the asset sitting in the middle of one of them.

And they land within 18 days of each other.

I do not think there is a tidier fact anywhere in crypto, and it is the one I most want you to carry around with you over the next couple of years.

The rule of thumb I use

My rule of thumb is about 1,064 days up and about 364 days down. The 1,064 is the average of the 2 up legs before this one, 1,068 and 1,061 days, and this last one came in at 1,050. The down legs have run 363, 376 and 410 days, so think of the 364 as **roughly a year**, never an exact date.

What this is actually for. Not for calling a date. For calibrating your patience. If the historical shape holds even loosely, the up leg is measured in YEARS. So the panic you feel about missing a move this week is almost certainly the wrong emotion at the wrong timescale, and now you have 3 numbers to prove that to yourself with.

How long have you been assuming all of this takes? Write down the number you have been carrying around in your head without checking it.

Why this helps: *when you know a run takes years, missing a week stops feeling like an emergency.*

2.2 CONTINUED

SEE IT FOR YOURSELF

Every day of Bitcoin's price since 2013, with each run counted.



Bitcoin in US dollars, daily closing price on the Bitstamp exchange, log scale. Highs and lows are the highest and lowest trade of that day. Checked against Bitfinex, Coinbase and Binance: from 2017 on, all 4 exchanges agree on every high and low to the day. The 2013 top was Nov 30 on Bitstamp and Dec 4 on Bitfinex, so that first drop runs 406 to 411 days depending on where you look. Halving dates are read from the blockchain. Data to Sep 30, 2026.

THE HALVING CLOCK

THE HALVING	THE TOP	PRICE AT THE TOP	TIME AFTER THE HALVING	
Nov 28, 2012	Nov 30, 2013	\$1,163	12 months	367 days
Jul 9, 2016	Dec 17, 2017	\$19,666	17.3 months	526 days
May 11, 2020	Nov 10, 2021	\$69,000	18 months	548 days
Apr 20, 2024	Oct 6, 2025	\$126,272	17.5 months	534 days

The last 3 tops all came 17 to 18 months after the halving. 536 days on average.

The next halving (about every 4 years, the number of new Bitcoin created gets cut in half) is expected around April 2028. Add 17 to 18 months and you land in late September or early October 2029. Count from top to top instead, and you land in September 2029.

Hold it loosely. Four halvings is a tiny sample, and 2013 topped 6 months earlier than the rest. Use this for patience, never for a date. A plan that only works if the top arrives on schedule is not a plan.

2.3

THE CYCLE STARTS LATER THAN YOU THINK

And why I find that reassuring.

THE AWKWARD FACT

Bitcoin's **first all time high, in June 2011 at about \$31.50, came before the first halving**, which did not happen until November 2012.

So that first boom cannot have been driven by the halving. It was early adopter enthusiasm and very little else. The steady rhythm everybody describes only really starts with the 2013 cycle. Since then it has held 3 times out of 3.

Cycle turning points per Fidelity Digital Assets (2026).

I find this genuinely reassuring rather than alarming, and it took me a while to figure out why.

It means the pattern is not magic. It is a supply shock (suddenly fewer new coins) meeting human behavior, and it took a few years to settle into a recognizable shape. Anything that took a few years to settle into a shape can also change shape, and knowing that keeps you honest in a way that treating it as a law never would.

It also means that when somebody quotes the 4 year cycle at you as though it were gravity, they are quoting 3 data points. Three. You would not build a trading system on 3 trades.

And about 2028

The next halving is expected around April 2028, and a great many people have therefore decided that 2028 is the year of the peak.

But if you take the historical spacing seriously, 2 completely separate ways of counting both land somewhere in September or October 2029. One counts the average gap between all time highs. The other counts the average lag from a halving to the peak that follows it. They count in 2 different ways, and they still land within a few weeks of each other.

So 2028 is the halving year, not the peak year. Those are 2 different things and mixing them up is one of the most common mistakes I see. If you have been quietly planning around 2028 as your exit, this page might be the most valuable one in the book for you. But please read the next page too, because I am not asking you to swap one date for another one.

2.4

THE MULTIPLES ARE GETTING SMALLER

The part nobody puts on a graphic, so here it is on one.

THE NUMBERS

CYCLE LOW TO THE NEXT ALL TIME HIGH

2011 to 2013		569x
2015 to 2017		104 to 130x
2018 to 2021		21.5x
2022 to 2025		8.0x

DROP FROM THE TOP TO THE LOW

2011		93.7%
2013 to 2015		83.9%
2017 to 2018		83.4%
2021 to 2022		76.9%

High to high: 36x, then 16.75x, then 3.56x, then 1.85x. The same shrinking trend, from only 4 data points.

Green bars on a log scale. Per the cycle turning points above, Fidelity Digital Assets (2026).

If your plan quietly assumes another 100 bagger (a coin that goes up 100 times) on your whole portfolio, this is the page to read twice.

The market is very much bigger than it was. It takes vastly more money to move it now, and the days when a relatively small amount of enthusiasm could double the price are behind us, at least for Bitcoin itself. That is what maturity looks like and it is the price of the institutions arriving.

The good news hiding in exactly the same trend

The drawdowns (how far the price falls from its top) are getting smaller too. Peak to trough they run **93.7%, then 83.9%, then 83.4%, then 76.9%**. Each cycle has hurt a bit less than the one before it.

So a realistic picture of a maturing asset is smaller upside AND smaller downside. Which, if you are honest with yourself, is a considerably easier thing to hold through than what the people who were here in 2013 had to survive.

What I would actually do with this. Not despair. Adjust the size of the story you are telling yourself. A run that is smaller than the last one is still a run, and a plan built for a realistic number will survive contact with reality. A plan built for a 100 bagger will have you holding through the entire thing waiting for a number that may not be coming, and then holding all the way back down again.

What multiple has your plan been quietly assuming? Write it down, and then write a more realistic one next to it.

Why this helps: a plan that waits for a 100x never takes profit. A realistic number gives you real levels to sell at, so you actually bank some of this run instead of holding it all the way back down.

2.5

WHAT IF THE CYCLE BREAKS?

This is the page that makes the last 3 pages safe to read.

I have just given you some very tidy numbers, and tidy numbers are dangerous, so let us deal with that properly.

The sample is 4 cycles and only 3 of them count. The conditions have changed materially: spot exchange traded funds did not exist before, neither did this level of institutional ownership, or these regulations, or this interest rate environment. Every one of those is exactly the sort of thing that breaks a historical pattern.

And a pattern is a description, not a mechanism. Knowing that the last 3 up legs took about 1,060 days tells you what happened. It does not tell you what will happen, and the gap between those 2 things is where an enormous amount of money has been lost by people who were extremely confident.

So here is the test I want you to apply to your own plan, and it is a much better use of these numbers than picking a date.

YOUR PLAN HAS TO WORK IN ALL 3 OF THESE

It has to work if the peak comes in 2028.

It has to work if the peak comes in 2029.

And it has to work if this cycle looks nothing whatsoever like the last 3, and the shape everybody is expecting simply does not turn up.

If your plan only works in one of those, it is not a plan. It is a bet on a date, and you have dressed it up in research so that it feels like analysis.

A plan that survives all 3 usually looks quite boring. It sells in sections on the way up rather than aiming at a top. It has rules that trigger on price and behavior rather than on the calendar. And it does not require you to be right about when.

This is the whole reason we call it Present Moment Trading. Not because dates and cycles are useless, they are genuinely useful for patience and for scale. But because the trade in front of you right now is the only one you can actually do anything about, and a plan that depends on a year being correct is a plan that has quietly handed your outcome to a calendar.

Does your current thinking survive all 3? Which one breaks it?

Why this helps: if one of those breaks your plan, you get to fix it now, while fixing it costs nothing.



PART 3

THE RUN STARTS

Tuesday morning. Your phone is going. Here we go.

From here on, this book stops explaining and starts putting you in it.

You are going to read a scene, decide what you would do, and only THEN find out what was happening inside you while you decided. That order matters, so please do not read ahead.

- 1 Simulator: the breakout**
- 2 Why the chase feels like that**
- 3 What attention does to a price**



3.1

IT HAS STARTED

Read this, then answer before you turn the page.

BULL RUN SIMULATOR 2**Tuesday, 9:17 a.m.**

Bitcoin has broken out overnight (pushed above a price it kept failing to get past). You woke up to it.

Your portfolio is up \$17,420 since Friday.

A coin you nearly bought last month is up 84%.

Your friend texts: **"Are you in XYZ???"**

You open X and everybody is talking about it. Two people you follow have posted their numbers.

You have not eaten. You are still in yesterday's t-shirt. It is 9:17 in the morning.

What do you do next? Write it down before you read on.

And what is happening in your body while you read that? Chest, jaw, hands, breathing, the urge to reach for your phone.

Why this helps: noticing your body is your first warning that excitement is about to make a decision for you.

Whatever you wrote, it is fine. There is no grade here. But keep your finger in this page, because the next 2 pages are about what was actually going on while you were deciding, and it is not what most people assume.

3.2

WHY THE CHASE FEELS LIKE THAT

The thing I could never explain until I read about it.

Let me describe something and you tell me if you recognize it.

The market has been going up for 4 days. You are making coffee and you check your phone. Then you check it again in the bathroom. Then again while somebody is actually talking to you, which you feel a bit guilty about but not guilty enough to stop.

And every single time you look, there is a small rush. A little hit of something.

Now here is the strange part, and this is the bit that confused me for years. When the trade finally does the thing you wanted it to do, when the money is actually there, you are happy for about 5 minutes. Then you are already looking for the next one.

Why is the waiting more exciting than the winning?

HERE IS THE ANSWER

Your brain runs **wanting** and **liking** on 2 different systems, and they can come apart completely.

Wanting is generated by large, robust dopamine circuits, and the key thing is that it fires hardest at **cues**. Not at rewards. At the signals that a reward might be coming.

Liking, the actual pleasure of getting the thing, runs on much smaller and more fragile systems and does not depend on dopamine at all.

Which means you can want something enormously and enjoy it very little, and that is not a personality defect. That is the architecture.

Berridge & Robinson, on incentive salience and the wanting/liking distinction.

So the rush while you were checking your phone was the wanting system doing exactly what it evolved to do. And the flatness 5 minutes after the win was the liking system, which was never built to give you a parade.

And now think about what a bull market actually is, from your body's point of view. It is a cue machine. Green candles, notifications, screenshots in the group chat, somebody you know posting a number. Every single one of those is a reward cue, and every single one of them turns the wanting up, whether or not there is anything sensible to do about it.

Which gives you something practical. The excitement is not information. It feels like information. It feels like your gut telling you something important, and sometimes it genuinely is. But a great deal of the time it is your dopamine system responding to a screen, and there is a simple way to tell the 2 apart. If it was on your written list BEFORE the excitement arrived, it is a trade. If it arrived WITH the excitement, it is a cue.

3.3

WHAT ATTENTION DOES TO A PRICE

You are not being stupid. You are being shown things in a particular order.

THE SCIENCE

Fear of missing out has a research literature and a validated scale. It is defined as the anxiety that others are having rewarding experiences you are absent from, and here is the part that matters for us: people lower in the basic psychological needs for **competence, autonomy and relatedness** report higher levels of it.

In other words, feeling like you do not know what you are doing, and feeling alone in it, are the exact conditions that crank FOMO up.

Przybylski, Murayama, DeHaan & Gladwell (2013), Computers in Human Behavior.

Now put that next to what happens to attention in a rising market.

AND IT SHOWS UP IN THE ACTUAL BUY ORDERS

Research on individual investors finds that **attention grabbing assets are subject to systematic buying pressure**. Faced with thousands of possible choices, retail investors buy what is in front of them.

The buy side herding this produces is **stronger in bull markets**, and platforms designed around notifications and gamified feeds produce predictable herding patterns.

Barber & Odean (2008); Barber, Huang, Odean & Schwarz (2022), on Robinhood users.

So the sequence is not mysterious once you see it written down. Something goes up. Going up makes it visible. Visibility brings buyers. Buyers push it up further, which makes it more visible still.

By the time it has reached you through a screenshot in a group chat, you are not early. You are the visibility.

And you are not doing anything stupid when this happens to you. You are responding reasonably to the information you were given, in the order you were given it. The problem is the order, and you did not choose it.

The defense is embarrassingly simple. Decide what you are buying BEFORE the excitement arrives, and write it down. Anything added after goes in a separate column and waits 72 hours. Almost nothing survives 72 hours, and that is the point.

What did you buy last cycle because you saw it somewhere rather than because it was on a plan?

Why this helps: seeing your own pattern once makes it much easier to catch the next time a screenshot tempts you.



PART 4

THE MIDDLE, WHERE IT GETS DANGEROUS

Everything is working. This is the part that costs people the run.

Most beginners assume emotional trading means panicking after a loss. That is the obvious one and it is not the expensive one.

The expensive one is what happens to you after you WIN, and almost nobody warns you about it, because it does not feel like a problem while it is happening. It feels wonderful.

1

Simulator: you are up

2

Why winning makes you dangerous

3

The week I made \$200,000



4.1

UP \$30,000 IN 3 WEEKS

Same rules as before. Read it, decide, write it down, then turn the page.

BULL RUN SIMULATOR 3**Three weeks later**

You started this run with \$20,000. You are now at \$50,000.

You have been right about basically everything for 3 weeks.

Two people have asked you what you are buying. One of them is somebody whose opinion you care about.

A setup appears. It is not really on your plan, but it looks a lot like one that has worked twice already this month.

It would be a \$5,000 position. Which is 10% of your account, and it is also money you did not have 3 weeks ago.

Do you take it? And how big?

Now the honest question. Would you have taken that same trade, at that same size, on the first morning of this run when you had \$20,000?

***Why this helps:** if your answer changed, you have just found where winning starts changing your position size.*

That gap is the whole chapter. If your answer changed, nothing about the trade changed. Only you did.

4.2

WHY WINNING MAKES YOU DANGEROUS

The one nobody warns you about.

THE SCIENCE

Two findings from the same body of work, and together they explain most blown accounts.

The **house money effect**: after a gain, people take risks they would never take with money they had earned, because winnings do not feel entirely like theirs yet.

The **break even effect**: after a loss, gambles that offer a route back to zero become unusually attractive, so a loss pushes people toward MORE risk rather than less.

Thaler & Johnson (1990), Management Science.

Look at what happened in that scenario you just answered.

You turned \$20,000 into \$50,000. And somewhere in there, \$5,000 quietly stopped being \$5,000 and became "profit", which is a completely different substance as far as your body is concerned. Profit feels like it belongs to the market rather than to you, so risking it does not feel like risking anything.

It is your money. It was always your money. But it does not feel like the \$20,000 you started with, and so you will take a trade with it that you would never have taken on day one.

And there is a second thing stacked on top of it, which is worse and quieter.

Three weeks of being right does something to a person. Confidence is a physical state, not just an opinion, and after a run of wins your body starts treating uncertainty as though it has been solved. You stop checking things. Position sizes drift up. The plan starts to feel like training wheels rather than a plan.

FROM MY OWN TRADING**The week I made \$200,000 and what it did to me**

My first really exciting week was the week I made over \$200,000 in a week.

And I want to be honest about what that actually does to your head, because nobody who posts a screenshot ever tells you the next part.

You do not think, great, the system works, let me keep running the system. That would be the sensible response and it is not what happens. What happens is that the number resets what normal feels like. Suddenly a good ordinary week looks disappointing. A careful entry looks slow. The size you were trading last month looks a bit timid.

The very first time, I had planned the trade for a year, so the win just felt like the plan working. The big weeks later on felt different. They felt like a new normal, and that is the dangerous part.

The winning is not the problem. The problem is what winning does to your idea of what is normal, and then you go and make decisions from that new normal.

Two rules that beat both effects, and I use both. First, gains are yours the moment they exist. Move a percentage somewhere you do not look at and treat what is left as capital, not winnings. Second, write your position sizing as a percentage rule with a hard ceiling, and do not let a good month move the ceiling. The ceiling is there for exactly the version of you who is on a winning streak.

After your best week, what changed about how you traded the following week? Go and check if you can.

Why this helps: *if your size crept up after a good week, you now know exactly where your ceiling needs to be.*



PART 5

THE DROP

It happens in every single cycle. Usually more than once.

I am going to tell you about the worst trading day of my life in this part.

Not because I enjoy telling it, but because everything I know about how to survive a crash I learned on that one afternoon, and most of it I learned by doing the exact opposite of what I should have done.

1

Simulator: down 30%

2

The biggest crash I had seen

3

Pad it to zero or cut it

4

How calm you have to be

5

My brother called

6

I have lost in every way

7

When you are beating yourself up

8

Write this now, read it when it drops



5.1

DOWN 30%

Last simulator before I tell you my own version. Answer it first.

BULL RUN SIMULATOR 4**It has been falling for 6 hours**

Your account is down 30% from where it was on Monday.

It is still falling. Every time you refresh, it is lower.

The group chat has gone from euphoric to silent, and the silence is somehow worse.

Somebody you follow has just posted that this is the top and the cycle is over.

You are up on the position overall, but you are giving back gains you had already started spending in your head.

What do you do in the next 10 minutes?

Before you read on, one important thing. I am not about to tell you that big drops mean you should always hold. Sometimes cutting is exactly right. What I am going to tell you is much narrower and much more useful: **a big drop is precisely the moment when you must not invent a new strategy.** Whatever you do in the next 10 minutes should be something you decided on a calm day. If it is not, that is the actual problem, not which direction you chose.

5.2

THE BIGGEST CRASH I HAD SEEN

FROM MY OWN TRADING

The day I was right about everything except the one that mattered

Bitcoin fell by about half in a day. The trend was clearly GREEN and going up, and then the news hit and people panicked. It fell in MINUTES. All day it fell. At the time it was the biggest, most epic crash any of us had ever seen.

I was trading hard that day. And here is the thing I want you to notice, because it is the whole point of the story.

I knew what was happening. I was posting in the group telling everyone to short every single pump (bet on the price falling after each quick jump up), and I was RIGHT.

But not Bitcoin.

On Bitcoin I cut my long (my bet that the price would go up), and then instead of shorting it like I was telling everybody else to do, I tried to SAVE it. I started padding the account (adding more money so the exchange would not close my trade). And when that was not enough, I went and took from my OTHER accounts to keep padding it.

Read that again. I was pulling money out of accounts that were fine, accounts that were WORKING, and feeding them into the one position I could not be objective about. My whole system is built on separate accounts precisely so that one bad trade cannot touch the others. And there I was, on the worst day of the year, taking my own protection apart with my own hands.

And it still was not enough. It kept falling.

10 bitcoin in one account. 14 in another. 24 coins.

I took a big hit that day. A really big one. And it was not because I read the market wrong. I read it perfectly. I was telling the entire group exactly what was about to happen.

It was because Bitcoin was the one I cared about.

I could short anything else all day long, no problem, because everything else was just a trade. Bitcoin was MINE. And the moment it was mine, I stopped trading it and started protecting it, and protecting it is what cost me. Then protecting it started costing me the other accounts too, because that is what a position like that does. It does not just take itself. It reaches.

And here is the part I most want you to take. The multiple accounts rule did not fail me. I BROKE it. I had the system, built years earlier for exactly that situation, sitting right there doing its job, and in the moment I reached straight past it. My rules were good. Most of them are unchanged today. What I did not have that afternoon was the STATE required to follow my own rules, and a rule you cannot follow is not protecting you from anything. That is what this whole book is about.

The stranger test

We all give better advice to a stranger than to ourselves. So let us use that.

1. Name a coin you feel loyal to. The one you would defend at a dinner party.

2. A stranger owns that coin, and it just dropped 30%. What would you tell them to do?

3. Now it is yours, and it just dropped 30%. What would you actually do?

If your 2 answers are different, you have found it. That is the coin you love too much to trade clearly. The advice you gave the stranger is your plan. Write it down as a rule for yourself now, while you are calm.

4. My rule for that coin:

Why this helps: the gap between your 2 answers is exactly where my 24 bitcoin went.

5.3

PAD IT TO ZERO OR CUT IT

A side lesson, and a rule I now follow without exception.

When a trade goes against you there are only 2 good answers, and everything in between them is where people get hurt.

OPTION 1. PAD IT TO ZERO.

If you are going to add to protect a position, you add enough to push your liquidation price (the price where the exchange closes your trade and the money is gone) all the way to zero, or as near to zero as you can physically get it. You want a liquidation price the market cannot reach. Not a further away one. An unreachable one.

OPTION 2. CUT IT.

Cut it and go with the direction the market is actually showing you, or cut with a stop loss (an order that sells for you automatically at a price you set). Done. Take the small loss and go and look for a better entry, because there will be another one.

Pad it to zero, or cut it. If you cannot get it to zero, you do not pad at all. You cut.

Half padding is the most tempting thing in the world because it FEELS like you are doing something, and it is the worst of the 3 options available to you. All you have really done is move your liquidation slightly further away and hand the market a bigger position to take.

I did not lose that bitcoin because I padded. I lost it because I padded a LITTLE, and then a little more, and then a little more out of accounts that had nothing to do with it.

And here is why I actually care about this rule now

It has almost nothing to do with the money.

When a position is padded to zero there is no stress. None. The market can do whatever it likes overnight and I sleep, because there is no number it can reach that takes anything from me. My body is not in the trade any more.

When a position is padded a little, I am in it every minute. Checking. Calculating. Wondering whether to add more. And a half protected position does not just risk your money, it takes your JUDGMENT away for as long as you hold it, and you need that judgment for everything else you are doing that week.

So padding to zero is not really a risk rule at all. It is a nervous system rule that happens to be written in contracts. No stress this way. That is the actual reason I do it.

5.4

HOW CALM YOU HAVE TO BE

The part of that day nobody talks about.

On the worst afternoon of my trading life, I had to do real math while my whole body was in a panic. Here is what that does to a brain.

THE SCIENCE

A review of the neuroscience puts it bluntly. Even quite mild **uncontrollable** stress causes "a rapid and dramatic loss of prefrontal cognitive abilities". Under stress, control shifts away from the prefrontal cortex, which is the slow, careful, rule following part, and toward faster and more habitual circuits.

A position falling while you can do nothing about it is a textbook uncontrollable stressor.

Arnsten (2009), Nature Reviews Neuroscience.

Now go back and look at what I was actually doing that afternoon.

Cutting a long. Opening a short. Calculating padding. Figuring out whether I could get a liquidation price low enough. That is real arithmetic, with contracts and leverage and margin (the money you put up to borrow the rest), and it has to be RIGHT, and I was doing it while the number on my screen fell in minutes and every group chat I was in lost its mind.

So the traders who make good moves in a crash are not braver or smarter than you. They are the ones who can still THINK, and thinking in that moment is a physical state, not a personality trait.

This is why I have always told my students to meditate, and I want to reclaim that from the incense and the whale music. It is not a spiritual instruction when I say it. A calm body can still do math. A panicked body cannot.

WHAT I DO NOW, AND YOU SHOULD STEAL IT

Before I touch anything in a crash, I take 3 long slow breaths out, longer out than in. Fifteen seconds. Then I look at the plan rather than at the price.

Fifteen seconds feels impossible when everything is falling. It is not, and whatever you were about to do in a blind panic is almost always worse than what you will do 15 seconds later.

And if you cannot get calm, do not trade. Cut, or close the laptop, and come back when your hands are steady. I have taken those trades. They are how this chapter got written.

In the last big crash, what did you do in the first 10 minutes? Could you actually do math?

Why this helps: knowing how you really react in a crash tells you which rules you need written down before the next one.

5.5

MY BROTHER CALLED TO SAY CONGRATULATIONS

FROM MY OWN TRADING

The bit people skip

A little while after that crash, Bitcoin started climbing again, and my brother called me to say congratulations.

He was being sweet. He knew I was in Bitcoin, he saw the price going up, and he was genuinely happy for me.

And I had nothing. I had lost the Bitcoin. The only thing I still had was a little in another account.

I do not think I can properly describe what that phone call felt like. Somebody you love, delighted for you, about money you do not have any more.

So let me be honest about what happened next, because I did not handle it beautifully. I felt sorry for myself. Genuinely. Woe is me, the whole thing.

And I am telling you that because people who teach this stuff pretend they went straight from the loss to the lesson, and that is nonsense. There is a bit in the middle where you feel awful, and you are allowed to have it.

Just do not move in.

What actually got me out of it is going to sound too simple, so I am going to tell you exactly what I did and you can judge it for yourself.

I started waking up and walking. A no music walk. No podcast, nothing in my ears. Just me and the outside and whatever my head was doing, and some of those walks were not pleasant, especially at the start.

I started dancing in the backyard with my headphones on. I would dance in my room. On my own, looking ridiculous, no audience.

I was generally silly and goofy again, which I had completely stopped being somewhere in the middle of losing all that money.

And I know how that sounds sitting next to a story about 24 bitcoin. Anna, you lost a fortune and your solution was a dance in the backyard?

Yes. That is exactly what I did. And that is when miracles happen. I do not mean that as a cute line, I mean it as something I have now watched happen enough times to rely on. The good stuff starts arriving again once you stop being braced and start being a bit silly.

And then, crucially, I went back to PROCESS. Not to the money. Not to how far back I was or how long it would take to return to where I had been. Back to the process of trading. Back to looking for entries. Back to the boring repeatable thing.

I turned a little into a lot.

5.6

I HAVE LOST IN EVERY WAY YOU CAN LOSE

And I am still here.

That crash was not the only time. Not even close.

A business partner took our website, emptied the bank account and locked me out. In the morning it was our business. By the afternoon I could not even log in.

In another business, my partner started spending our advertising money on a BMW, and then on anything else he wanted. When I said something he told me, "But I never had such a nice car in my life." He stopped working. I did all of it, and he kept spending.

I held onto the anger about both of them for far too long. It never touched them once. It only ever burned me.

A supplier kept \$30,000 of my products and tried to tell me customs took them.

Then my divorce. I paid him to leave a house I had 90% paid off, and I took out a loan to do it. I paid him a lot. And I would pay it again, because what I got back was my freedom. I had almost nothing and I felt amazing. Nobody telling me what to do. Room to heal. Room, one day, to love somebody properly, without the drama and without the trauma.

If you can be happy on your own, you can love somebody without needing them. That is the only kind of love I want now.

And good relationships do exist. I want you to hear that from me. Falling in love is easy. Having sex is easier. Being with someone who can spark your soul, that is rare. And it exists. Choose somebody who never leaves you lying awake wondering if you still matter to them.

And in a different crash, I watched \$1.3M disappear in seconds.

E-commerce. Investments. Crypto. Love. You can lose in any of them. I have lost in all of them.

And every single time, I came out on top.

It hurt every time. I kept going anyway, and that is the whole difference. When you lose money you do not lose everything. You keep what it taught you. You start again, and this time you start with experience, which is something you did not have the first time. You have the knowledge to make it back.

Who you keep around you

Surround yourself with people who get it, people who hold you up on the red days. If you trade, invest or run a business, you need a loving, supportive partner or nobody at all. Somebody who makes you smaller will cost you more than any bad trade ever will.

Trading is not for the weak. It will show you more about yourself than anything else you will ever do. How patient you really are. How greedy. How you talk to yourself when you are wrong. A job can let you hide from those things for years. A chart shows you in a week.

Who you tell

Here is something I would do differently. Do not tell people you are in crypto. I already got this one wrong, I made a whole brand out of it, but if I started again I would be incognito. People will have their opinions, and their opinions will be loudest on your worst days.

And if you already told them, and they bought because of you, and then it crashed and they blamed you, here is what I would do. Be kind, and do not argue. You have no idea what that loss landed on top of. You shared what you were doing. They decided what to do with their own money. Do not promise them it will come back, and never offer to cover their losses out of guilt. You cannot trade for 2 people. Next time, share how you think, never what to buy.

And some people will never like you anyway. Your spirit irritates their demons.

The question I ask myself

Get into the habit of asking yourself this, about everything: *"Does this support my life and what I am trying to create?"*

When you trade you need to be very focused. Every bit of drama you do not need is taking attention away from your screen and from your plan. If it does not support your life, cut it off. The bad friend. The bad relationship. The group chat that only ever makes you panic. You will be amazed how much clearer you trade when there is less noise around you.

Who gets to stay

Anybody who encourages your growth is worth keeping. Intellectual, emotional, artistic, spiritual, any of it. Honestly, those are the only people who should be welcomed into your life.

I have spent years pouring myself into people who were never going to pour anything back. I do not do that any more. Over the years I have developed zero tolerance for a few things:

- Gossip.
- Excuses.
- No personal accountability.
- Dishonesty.
- Laziness. That is not the same as resting. We need rest.
- Emotional immaturity.
- Anyone my soul rejects straight away, even when I do not understand why.

When your gut tells you to step away from somebody, step away. You do not need a reason you can explain.

You need your own list. Write down what you want in your life, and then say no to everything that is not that.

WHAT I WANT IN MY LIFE	WHAT I AM SAYING NO TO

Why this helps: *when you know exactly what you want, saying no gets fast and guilt free.*

Sometimes the small life has to break so there is room for the big one. Sometimes our lives have to be completely shaken up, changed and rearranged to move us to the place we are meant to be. I could not see that in the middle of any of it. I can see it now.

And if you went through your darkest time alone, you will start acting like you do not need anybody. I did. You do not have to stay that hard. You can open up again. Things get better.

I say it to myself all the time:

"Universe, show me how good it gets."

5.7

WHEN YOU ARE BEATING YOURSELF UP

Read this page on the day. That is what it is for.

THE SCIENCE, AND IT SURPRISES EVERYBODY

People assume that being hard on yourself after a mistake is what stops you repeating it. The research says close to the opposite.

Students who **forgave themselves** for procrastinating before one exam went on to procrastinate **less** before the next one, and the effect ran through reduced negative feeling. Separately, across 4 experiments, a brief self-compassionate framing after a failure made people study **longer** after failing a hard test, and more motivated to put things right, than a self-esteem boost did.

Being kind to yourself after a loss made people work harder. Not softer.

Wohl, Pychyl & Bennett (2010), Personality and Individual Differences; Breines & Chen (2012), PSPB.

I want to say something to you about the voice in your head right now, assuming you are reading this page for a reason.

You think you are an idiot for letting it happen. You are running the tape of the exact moment you could have done something different, over and over, and each time it plays you feel it again as though it were happening now.

You are not a loser. You made a mistake, and it is a mistake that big millionaires make, and some of them make it more than once. I have made it more than once.

This is one chapter in your story. It is not the whole book.

And self criticism feels like having standards, which is why it is so hard to put down. It is not standards. It is a way of paying for the loss emotionally so that you feel entitled to move on, and it burns exactly the fuel you need for the next decision.

SO HERE IS WHAT TO ACTUALLY DO, IN ORDER

1. Name it out loud. Not "I feel bad". Precisely. "I am ashamed that I broke my own rule in front of myself." Putting a feeling into specific words measurably reduces its charge (Lieberman and colleagues, 2007), and vague words do not do it.

2. Move your body before you think about it any more. Walk. No music. Dance in your kitchen if nobody is home. Get outside. You are not avoiding the problem, you are getting your prefrontal cortex back so you can actually look at it.

3. Say the sentence. "I made a mistake that experienced people make. I am going to take the lesson and I am not going to take the punishment."

4. Get the lesson. One sentence. What actually happened, mechanically.

5. Turn the lesson into a RULE. This is the whole conversion and it is the reason any of this was worth it. Loss into lesson into rule. Once it is a rule you never have to have that particular argument with yourself again.

6. Go back to process. Not to the money. One boring repeatable task. Then another one.

Every rule I teach in every one of my classes was made this way, and most of them cost me something. That is genuinely all a rule is. It is a lesson that somebody paid for and then wrote down so they would never pay for it twice.

You cannot move forward while you are treating yourself like the enemy.

A baby falls down 50 times learning to walk and never once decides walking is not for them. Neither should you.

5.8

WRITE THIS NOW, READ IT WHEN IT DROPS

Fill this in now, while it is quiet, so it is already written when you need it.

1. The lesson. If you have taken a real loss before, what did it actually teach you? One sentence, and no self criticism allowed in it.

2. The rule. Now turn that into a rule you can follow when you are upset. Start with "I will always" and "I will never".

3. The body part. What is your walk, your dance, your silly thing? Name the actual activity and the actual time of day.

4. The process part. What is the first boring repeatable trading task you go back to? Not a trade. A task.

5. Your person. Who has actually been through a loss and would understand? Write their name, and message them before you need to.

AND WRITE THIS AT THE BOTTOM IN YOUR OWN HANDWRITING: "THIS IS A CHAPTER, NOT THE BOOK."

Why this helps: on a bad day you will not have to think. You will just read what the calm version of you already wrote.



PART 6

THE TOP, AND NOBODY RINGS A BELL

Being right about the direction is not the hard part.

Plenty of people were completely right about the last run and still gave most of it back, because they had no exit written down and no way of making one while everything was moving.

This part is about the only bit of a bull run that you fully control.

1 The one that went 100x

2 Selling the wrong thing

3 The exit nobody writes



6.1

THE ONE THAT WENT 100X

And why the 100x is not the lesson.

FROM MY OWN TRADING**MATIC, 2021, live on YouTube**

I want you to hold that crash in your head while I tell you this one, because they are really the same story.

In 2021 I was live on YouTube with my students. I had already sent the trade alert out beforehand, so they knew exactly what I was looking at. And I put \$50,000 down on MATIC, live, in front of everybody.

I bought at around \$0.029. And then, as it went UP, I kept buying.

Read that again, because it is backwards from what most people do. Most people add to the thing that is falling and hope, and leave the thing that is working alone because they are frightened of giving the gain back. I did the opposite. I added to the one that was proving itself.

MATIC did a 100x.

Do the math with me rather than just hearing the number. 100 times \$0.029 is \$2.90. That is what a 100x looks like on a coin priced in pennies, and it is why people get so silly about low priced coins.

Now put money on it. If you had put \$10,000 in at \$0.029 and it goes 100x, then \$10,000 times 100 is \$1,000,000.

Not every coin goes up like that. Most do not. But it is a lot of fun when one does, and in crypto almost anything is possible. I am not going to pretend otherwise just to sound responsible.

But here is the part I actually want you to take, because the number is not the lesson.

I sold in sections.

Not at the top. I have never once sold the top and neither has anybody you follow, whatever their screenshots say. I sold on the way up, in pieces, at levels I had decided on before it got loud.

Because here is what happens otherwise, and I know because I have done it. You watch it climb. You tell yourself you will sell at the next level. It hits that level, and now there is a new story about how it is going higher, so you wait. And then one day it is not going higher any more, and now you are holding and hoping and telling yourself it will come back.

Selling in sections takes that entire conversation away from you IN ADVANCE, which is the only time you were ever capable of having it properly.

Anything can happen in crypto. MATIC went all the way to \$2.909 at its all time high on some exchanges. From \$0.029, that is a 100x. The exact top was a little different on every exchange, so when you set your targets, know which chart your exchange is actually giving you.

Your selling levels

Pick a coin you hold, or want to hold. Before it gets loud, decide where you will sell a piece of it, and how much.

FIRST SECTION: THE PRICE, AND HOW MUCH I SELL

SECOND SECTION: THE PRICE, AND HOW MUCH I SELL

THIRD SECTION: THE PRICE, AND HOW MUCH I SELL

And where does the money from each section go? Be specific.

Why this helps: when the price is flying you will not have to decide anything. You just follow what you wrote today.

6.2

SELLING THE WRONG THING

A pattern so reliable it has a name and a price tag.

I have watched this one in my students for years, and I still feel the pull of it myself. Somebody actually measured it.

THE SCIENCE

Analysis of trading records from **10,000 brokerage accounts** found investors sold 14.8% of the winning positions they could have sold, and only 9.8% of the losing ones. Roughly **1.5 times more likely to sell a winner than a loser**. It was not explained by taxes, rebalancing or trading costs.

And it was expensive. The winners they sold went on to **outperform the losers they held by 3.4 percentage points over the following year**.

Odean (1998), The Journal of Finance.

This is called the disposition effect, and in a bull run it is brutal, because the thing you are cutting early is precisely the thing that was about to do all the work.

The emotional logic is easy to follow once you see it. Selling a winner feels like being right, and being right feels wonderful. Selling a loser feels like admitting you were wrong, and while you are still holding it you have not been wrong yet. You have just not been right YET.

So the account slowly fills up with everything that is not working, while everything that was working got sold early for a small gain and a nice feeling.

And I will tell you the version of this I know best, because it is the one I still feel. In the 2021 run I sold a portion of my Bitcoin at \$40,000. It went on to \$69,000. I watched it climb and, of course, calculated what I could have had, and I felt a small pang of regret every time.

I would do exactly the same again. That is what selling in sections costs you: a small, permanent, entirely survivable pang. I decided a long time ago that I would rather bank a great result than gamble it chasing a perfect one.

The fix is a rule, not a feeling. Decide your exits before you enter, in writing, including the one where you take some off and let the rest run. A rule made in advance is a rule made by the version of you who still had a prefrontal cortex.

Think of a position you cut too early. What was the actual feeling in the moment you clicked?

Why this helps: once you can name the feeling that made you sell, you can write a rule that catches it next time.

6.3

THE EXIT NOBODY WRITES

Everybody plans the entry. The money is in the other end.

The top does not announce itself. There is no bell.

What there is instead is a period where everything feels wonderful and every instinct you have says hold on for more, followed by a period where everything feels temporary and every instinct says wait for the bounce. A written exit is the only thing that survives both of those.

THE NUMBER AT WHICH I TAKE MY ORIGINAL STAKE BACK OFF THE TABLE

HOW MUCH I SELL ON THE WAY UP, AND AT WHICH LEVELS

WHAT I AM PREPARED TO HOLD THROUGH A 40% DRAWDOWN, AND WHAT I AM NOT

WHERE THE MONEY PHYSICALLY GOES WHEN I TAKE IT OUT. BE SPECIFIC.

That last box matters far more than it looks. If you have not decided where profit goes, it goes back into the market, because that is the path of least resistance and it does not feel like a decision at all. Deciding in advance is how people finish a cycle with something to show for it. It is also, and I mean this, how you buy a house.



PART 7

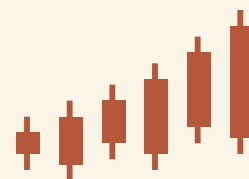
YOUR PLAN, WRITTEN WHILE IT IS QUIET

Because you will not be able to write one later. That is the entire point.

Everything up to here has been understanding. This part is the work, and it is the part that will still be useful to you in 2 years when you have forgotten most of the rest.

Write it in pen. Write it badly if you have to. A rough plan written today beats a perfect one you were going to write when things settled down.

- 1 Short enough to remember at 2am**
- 2 Decide it now, while you are calm**
- 3 The trade you have not taken yet, revisited**



7.1

SHORT ENOUGH TO REMEMBER AT 2AM

If you cannot say it while you are upset, it is too long.

People write trading plans like legal documents and then never read them again. What actually survives contact with a real market is a small number of rules you could recite while upset.

Write yours now. Not what you should do. What you WILL do.

WHAT I AM BUYING, AND WHY IT IS ON THE LIST

WHAT I WILL NEVER BUY, NO MATTER WHAT IT IS DOING

MY MAXIMUM POSITION SIZE, AS A PERCENTAGE, WITH A CEILING A GOOD MONTH CANNOT MOVE

MY PADDING RULE. TO ZERO, OR CUT. WRITE IT IN YOUR OWN WORDS.

WHERE MY COINS LIVE, AND WHO HOLDS THE KEYS

That last one is not filler. Plenty of people lose money to custody (who actually holds your coins) and trust rather than to bad chart reading. Hacks. Exchanges freezing withdrawals. Money handed to somebody else to look after. Almost nobody writes a rule about it.

7.2

DECIDE IT NOW, WHILE YOU ARE CALM

The best evidenced trick there is for actually doing what you said you would do.

THE SCIENCE

Across **94 independent tests and more than 8,000 participants**, plans in the form "if situation *X* happens, then I will do *Y*" moved goal attainment with a **medium to large effect, $d = 0.65$** .

They work by handing control to the situational cue instead of to your willpower, so the action fires without needing a decision. Which is exactly what you need, because by now you know that the moment you most need the decision is the moment the machinery for making it has already been degraded.

Gollwitzer & Sheeran (2006), Advances in Experimental Social Psychology.

The cue has to be observable. Not "when I feel greedy", because that is precisely the perception that fails you. And the THEN has to be a physical action, not a feeling.

Steal these. If something is up more than 30% in a day and it is not on my list, then I do nothing for 72 hours. If I have slept less than 6 hours, then I do not open the exchange. If I catch myself calculating what a number would mean for my life, then I close the laptop and go outside. If a position goes against me, then I pad it to zero or I cut it, and never anything in between. If the account hits my drawdown number, then I stop and I call the person I said I would call.

You do not really choose your future. You choose your habits, and your habits choose your future.

Now write yours. Borrow from the examples on the last page, or make your own.

1 IF

THEN I WILL

2 IF

THEN I WILL

3 IF

THEN I WILL

4 IF

THEN I WILL

5 IF

THEN I WILL

Why this helps: when the moment comes, the decision is already made, so you do not need willpower at 2am.

7.3

THE TRADE YOU HAVE NOT TAKEN YET, REVISITED

Go back to Part 1 and read what you wrote. No peeking at it until now.

That was you, before any of this. Same scene, same numbers, and now you know what is happening underneath it.

BULL RUN SIMULATOR 1

The same scene again

You have \$100,000 in your account.

A coin you nearly bought 3 days ago is up 60%.

Everybody in the Discord is talking about it. Somebody has posted that they are up \$28,000.

While you are reading that message, it moves another 12%.

Would you still do what you wrote in Part 1?

What changed? And which specific thing that you learned changed it?

***Why this helps:** it shows you which lessons actually changed what you would do.*

If your answer did not change, that is genuinely fine and it might mean your first instinct was sound. But go and check it against the 72 hour rule and your written list from 7.1. The test is not whether the answer changed. The test is whether it now comes from a rule instead of from a feeling.



PART 8

LESS TIME THAN YOU THINK

What this actually takes, hour by hour, with nothing exaggerated.

I am not going to tell you that you have no time, because I do not know your life and plenty of people reading this have plenty of it.

What I will do is lay out honestly what this takes, because the picture in most people's heads is wildly wrong in one direction and occasionally wrong in the other.



8.1

WHAT ACTUALLY NEEDS DOING

Most of what you imagine this takes, it does not take.

THE SCIENCE

Feeling short of time has a name, and it has real consequences. Researchers use the term **time poverty** for the persistent sense of having too much to do and not enough time to do it. People who report frequent time scarcity are less happy and more prone to anxiety and depression, and it tracks with lower wellbeing, health and productivity. Global wealth has risen for decades and time affluence has not moved with it at all.

Giurge, Whillans & West (2020), Nature Human Behaviour.

So if this is you, it is not an excuse and you are not making it up. It is something measurable that most of the developed world is living inside.

Here is how it comes out on our calls, word for word.

"Where do I find the time to start doing this?"

"I am inundated with a lot of stuff."

The picture in most people's heads is somebody at 6 screens all day, reacting to everything. That is a job, it is a stressful one, and it is not what this is.

DAILY, AND IT IS SHORT

Check your positions against your written plan. Not to react, but to confirm that nothing has hit a level you already made a decision about. Ten minutes if you are slow.

WEEKLY, AND THIS IS THE REAL WORK

Review what you did and why. Update the plan if something genuinely changed. Do your learning, one lesson at a time, in order. An hour, maybe 90 minutes, and it does not have to be in one sitting.

MONTHLY

Look at the whole picture. Position sizes, where your coins are living, whether the exit plan still matches your actual life. Half an hour.

NEVER, AND PLEASE HEAR THIS ONE

You do not need to watch it move. Watching does not improve outcomes and there is decent reason to think it makes them worse, because every glance is another chance for the wanting system to fire at a cue.

Some of the calmest and most profitable people I know look twice a day.

Add that up. 30 to 60 minutes a day at the very most while you are learning, dropping to a fraction of that once you know what you are doing. And I say the next bit with love, because I have been this person: it is less than most of us spend scrolling before we have gotten out of bed.

Learn this because it grows you. Whatever you learn, nobody can ever take it away from you.

When is your daily check? Write the time, and where you will be.

And when will you NOT look? Pick the hours your phone stays away from the charts.

Why this helps: a check at a set time is a habit. A check whenever you feel like it is the wanting system again.

8.2

THE WEEK YOU ACTUALLY HAVE

Fill it in honestly, chaos and all.

A plan that only works on a good week is not a plan. Build it for the ordinary one.

DAY	MY 10 MIN CHECK, WHEN	LEARNING BLOCK, IF ANY	REALISTIC?
Monday			
Tuesday			
Wednesday			
Thursday			
Friday			
Saturday			
Sunday			

If it does not fit, cut it rather than lying to yourself about it. Three honest days a week that actually happen will take you considerably further than 7 aspirational ones that collapse by Wednesday and leave you feeling like you have failed at something.

What are you going to stop doing to make room? Something has to go.

Why this helps: time has to come from somewhere, and choosing it on purpose is how the plan actually happens.



PART 9

WHO YOU WILL BE WHEN IT HAPPENS

The last thing I want to say to you before the run starts.

Two short pages. One takes you back to the person you were on page one and shows you what has actually changed.

The other is about why none of this was really about crypto.



9.1

BACK TO THE PERSON ON PAGE ONE

At the start of this book there was somebody excited and frightened at the same time, quietly figuring out what a good run might mean for their life, and quietly worried they had already missed it.

That person is still you. None of this removes the excitement or the fear, and honestly I would not want it to. Both of those are your body correctly reporting that something important might be about to happen.

But something has changed, and it is worth naming properly.

You still do not know what Bitcoin is going to do. Neither do I, and neither does anybody who tells you they do.

What you know now is what YOU are going to do.

You know how long these things have historically taken, so the panic about being 3 days late has lost most of its power over you. You know why the chase feels better than the win. You know that winning quietly changes what normal feels like, and that a loss will try to pull in everything around it. You know that a rule you cannot follow is not protecting you, and that the state comes first and the decision comes second.

And you have written it down, which almost nobody does.

One last thing, and it is the thing I would most want somebody to have told me the day after that crash.

Whatever this cycle does, you are going to get some of it wrong. I still do, and I have been at this since 2013. Getting some of it wrong is not the thing that decides how this goes for you. What decides it is whether you are still here afterwards, doing the boring repeatable thing, with your body calm enough to think. Even after you lose, you continue. That is the whole secret and it is not much of a secret.

AND ONE MORE THING

I said at the start that I wanted more for you than money out of this run, and I meant it, so let me finish there.

Everything in this book, all of it, is transferable. Learning to notice urgency and not obey it. Learning that being right is not the same as being calm. Learning to take the lesson without taking the punishment. Learning to come back after something knocks you down, and to be a bit silly on the way back.

Those are not trading skills that happen to help your life. They are life skills that happen to make you money here, and the trading is just the place where you get to practice them with immediate feedback and a number attached.

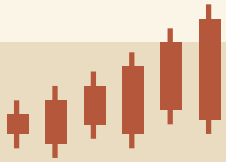
I have watched students get better at this and then get better at everything. Calmer with their families. Better at difficult conversations. Less frightened of being wrong in public. And I have watched it happen to me, which I did not expect at all when I spent a year studying Bitcoin and then bought my first one at \$100.

So go and do the work in here. Then get up in the morning and MOVE, and get to it.

Back to process. Back to looking for entries.

If you do nothing, nothing will happen.

This workbook is part of my Emotional Regulation class. If you do not have the class yet and you want the whole thing, DM me, Coach Brian or Coach Avi and we will tell you about it.



YOU KNOW WHAT YOU WILL DO

You still do not know what the market will do. Nobody does. But that was never the part you controlled.

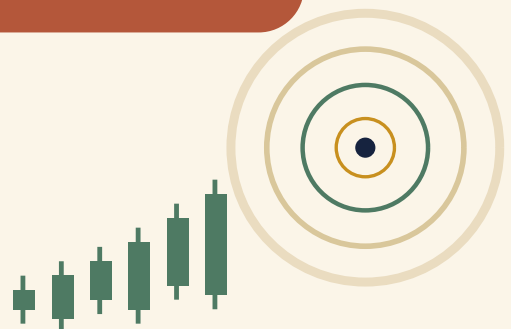
THE 6 THINGS TO CARRY WITH YOU

- 01** The last 3 up legs ran 1,068, 1,061 and 1,050 days. Patience here is measured in years, not weeks.
- 02** 2028 is the halving. The pattern points at 2029 for a peak. Your plan has to work if it is neither.
- 03** Excitement fires at cues, not at facts. If it was not on your list before the excitement, it waits 72 hours.
- 04** Winning quietly changes what normal feels like. Your position ceiling exists for the version of you on a winning streak.
- 05** Pad it to zero or cut it. Never in between. No stress this way.
- 06** Settle your body first, decide second. A rule you cannot follow is not protecting you from anything.

And whatever happens, remember the only thing I really needed you to hear. Even after you lose, you continue. This is a chapter, not the book.

<https://trading.lovingnetworking.com/>

Workbook 5 of the Peak Performance Protocol · Emotional Regulation
Education only. Not financial advice.



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